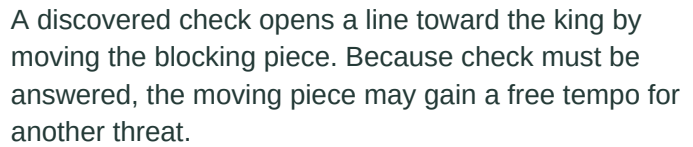


Discovered checks

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on c7. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22.e6+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The changed line means the bishop on f4 attacks the king on c7. Recorded reply: **22...Kd8**.

24.Kh1 The king moves from g1 to h1.

CHECKPOINT

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -4 to -3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.